

Assume the same thing will happen for implants. And once everyone gets them, how will natural selection kick in? Just as it does right now, where everyone has access to the technology, but some are just better at using it, eventually you're going to get people who make awesome cyborgs, and those that make terrible cyborgs. Guess who will be more successful and procreate?

Do this for a few thousand generations, and we will certainly see a Borg like race which is nothing like the human species of today. Even if we don't become mindless drones controlled by a hive mind as the Borg are, we are still headed for a future where technology just becomes a part of us.

HUMAN OR MACHINE?

The question remains is that will the resultant cyborg species that we will eventually evolve into (assuming the asteroid doesn't come first) be more machine like or will it be more human like? To be honest, I hate the question because of the assumptions it makes... let me explain...

Somehow we have got this idea into our heads that we are human, and we are special. And of course, machines are dumb and useless and lifeless, so they're inferior. To which I only have one thing to say:

What's the square root of 895646460996? While you scratch your head, my calculator has already spat out an answer: 946386. Want to bet my calculator is correct?

It's ridiculous to imagine machines as being inferior in any way to humans. This is merely our own hubris, because we think we're somehow special and that the universe exists to please us. Nothing can be further from the truth of course, but even if it was, we have to realise why machines were invented in the first place...

Many of you have already caught on to where I'm going, but I'm going to spell it out anyway. Although we may have started building machines as tools that would do what we couldn't physically, they're so much more than that now. Actually, let me correct that, no machine can do what a human cannot, not yet at least, it merely does it more efficiently, or more accurately.



Think you could dig a hole faster than this thing?

And it's not just mental stuff, we can do the same for physical stuff. I could dig a hole 100 metres square and 10 metres deep. It might take me a year, and may take someone physically more able than me a month, and someone less able than me a decade, but we'd do it eventually... if forced to... and sure, a machine might be able to dig that up in a day, and be far more precise in the measurements of the square and the depth than we ever would on our own, but we still could do it in theory.

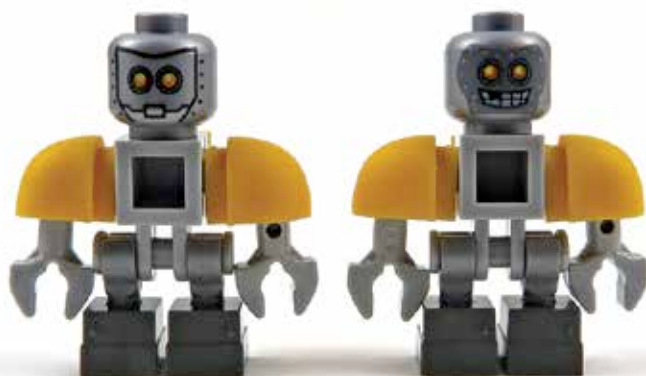
TECH SLAVES

Remember the news report from almost exactly a year ago (July 2017), where Facebook got two bots to talk to one another, and they soon invented their own language to talk to one another? Although the bots were taught to talk to one another in English, they soon abandoned it and started conversing in a made up language. Or

rather, that's what could be happening; we don't know for sure. I bring it up as an example of what a machine world left unto itself would be like. It would be totally alien to us, and we would never be able to comprehend it. We don't speak ant, so what makes us think sentient machines would speak English at all?

Now, compare that to the machines we have today, or the cybernetics we are working on. Thus far, we have only ever used machines to enhance human traits, and even when we make plans to become cyborgs, we're looking at enhancing our human abilities and brains. We want the machines to speak our language, to talk and think like us, and we only consider AI to be something that we would be able to recognise as intelligence.

Again, our hubris on display, because I honestly believe that if machines gain sentience, we might never even know. Heck they could be



Wonder what was so funny, and if the joke was in binary?